



# English H+ Practice Set

Writer: Vicky 10 (12)

Editor: Joyce 10 (1)

***Range: City of Glass and Vocabulary 3&4***

**Note: Review Practices are UNOFFICIAL sources of reference and do NOT include or hint at questions in the actual exam!**

1. What initially prompts Daniel Quinn to take on the role of a detective?

- a) A newspaper advertisement
- b) A letter from Peter Stillman Jr.
- c) A misdirected phone call for "Paul Auster, Private Investigator"
- d) A request from the real Paul Auster

2. Peter Stillman Sr.'s horrific experiments on his son were primarily focused on:

- a) Physical strength and endurance
- b) Developing psychic abilities
- c) Proving a theory about language and the pre-Babel state
- d) Creating a perfect heir to his fortune

3. What recurring visual motif is used to symbolize Quinn's psychological breakdown and the labyrinthine nature of reality?

- a) Floating eyeballs
- b) Shattered glass
- c) Mazes, spirals, and fragmented panels
- d) Flowing water

4. How does the graphic novel primarily end for Daniel Quinn?

- a) He solves the case and returns to writing.
- b) He confronts and defeats Stillman Sr.

- c) He finds peace living with Peter Stillman Jr.
- d) He becomes homeless, mentally broken, and obsessed with indecipherable notebooks, disappearing into the city.

5. The character of the real Paul Auster in the story primarily serves to:

- a) Provide Quinn with crucial detective assistance
- b) Act as a romantic rival for Virginia Stillman
- c) Blur the lines of identity and highlight themes of authorship
- d) Offer a scientific explanation for Stillman Sr.'s theories

6. The distinctive visual style of the graphic novel, characterized by stark shadows, clean lines, and deliberate pacing, is primarily the work of:

- a) Paul Auster
- b) Paul Karasik
- c) David Mazzucchelli
- d) Art Spiegelman

7. Peter Stillman Jr.'s unique manner of speaking is a direct result of:

- a) A childhood illness
- b) His father's linguistic isolation experiment
- c) A deliberate choice to reject society
- d) A head injury sustained later in life

8. What does Quinn's red notebook symbolize throughout the story?

- a) His financial success as a writer
- b) His connection to his deceased son
- c) His desperate attempt to impose order, meaning, and identity through language – which ultimately fails
- d) The clues leading to Stillman Sr.'s capture

9. The graphic novel fundamentally subverts the traditional detective genre by:

- a) Having the detective solve multiple complex cases
- b) Making the detective a flamboyant superhero
- c) Depicting the detective's utter failure, mental disintegration, and the unsolvable nature of the mystery
- d) Setting the story in a fantastical world instead of a city

10. The visual depiction of New York City in the graphic novel primarily emphasizes:

- a) Its vibrant nightlife and tourist attractions
- b) Its role as a warm, supportive community
- c) Its vastness, anonymity, labyrinthine qualities, and function as a character inducing alienation
- d) Its futuristic technology and architecture

Free Response Questions (FRQs)

1. Trace Daniel Quinn's psychological and physical descent throughout the graphic novel. What key events and realizations contribute to his ultimate breakdown and disappearance?
2. Analyze how David Mazzucchelli's artwork contributes significantly to the themes of *City of Glass*. Choose TWO specific themes (e.g., Identity, Reality vs. Illusion, Language/Failure, Alienation) and explain how visual elements (panel layout, shading, symbolism, character design, pacing) enhance them.
3. Discuss how *City of Glass* functions as a deconstruction or subversion of the traditional detective genre. What conventional tropes does it use, and how does it ultimately undermine or reject them?
4. Explore the theme of "authorship" within *City of Glass*. Consider the roles of Daniel Quinn, the real Paul Auster (character), Paul Auster (original author), and Paul Karasik & David Mazzucchelli (adapters). How does the graphic novel comment on the nature of creating stories and identities?